

Chapter 71 Part 6

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After bidding farewell to Gu Zhaoyuan, the car drove away from Ci'ai Nursing Home. For a while, neither of them spoke.

After returning home, Liang Shi drank some water, then said: "Let's sort out the timeline."

"I've already sorted it out." Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi: "?"

While she was driving, Xu Qingzhu had already sorted out the timeline. Now she just needed to write it down following her phone.

"Qi Jiao jumped in the summer of 2010, and Gu Zhaoyuan's younger sister Gu Xingyue died in a car accident at the end of 2010. Moreover, there were no photos of Gu Xingyue in the album Gu Zhaoyuan gave us. Only in the group photo that Gu Zhaoyuan kept could we see Gu Xingyue's face." Xu Qingzhu analyzed methodically. "In 2012, the old Director Gu fell seriously ill, then his mental state became somewhat abnormal. He converted the orphanage into a nursing home, and even said things like he had harmed the children."

"So..." Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu said in unison: "Gu Xingyue is the current Qi Jiao."

They hadn't expected things to progress so smoothly. The truth was right before their eyes.

"But why would Gu Xingyue stay by Mrs. Qi's side all the time? Logically speaking, given Director Gu's personality, if he discovered Gu Xingyue wasn't comfortable staying with Mrs. Qi, he would have taken her away, right?" Liang Shi wondered. "And why did it take a year before he discovered there was a problem?"

"That's something we'd have to ask Director Gu." Xu Qingzhu said: "But what I can't understand is, clearly Gu Xingyue was doing well with Director Gu. Why would Director Gu be willing to hand her over to Mrs. Qi?"

Liang Shi: "...For money?"

"That's possible. But I asked Luoxi, and she said Angel Orphanage wasn't too short on money back then because many wealthy people would donate to it." Xu Qingzhu said: "But we can't rule out that reason either."

It was truly a mystery.

Probably only those involved would know.

But discovering this was already quite good.

At least they didn't have to search for clues like headless flies anymore.

But knowing this truth made both Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu's hearts feel somewhat heavy. The original Qi Jiao had already passed away. What remained now was someone else's adopted daughter.

Because of this adopted daughter, a person who had been doing charity work for years was driven insane.

And in this world, there were still people who remembered her.

When Gu Zhaoyuan mentioned Gu Xingyue, his eyes still brimmed with tears.

Liang Shi's heart felt as if it was being pressed down by a large stone. The Qi Jiao she had seen in her dream was sensible, kind, and lovely, but her life had permanently stopped in her teenage years.

To help her ease her sad emotions, Xu Qingzhu teased: "Teacher Liang is quite good at getting things done. You actually thought to use donating money to soften Gu Zhaoyuan's heart."

"No." Liang Shi said in a low voice: "I genuinely want to do something for those children."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

Saying this made it seem like she was being narrow-minded.

However, when Xu Qingzhu saw those scenes, she didn't feel as sentimental as Liang Shi did.

At that time, when she saw Liang Shi observing those children, her eyes were red.

She guessed it was probably the empathy of an actor.

"You seem to place particular emphasis on education?" Xu Qingzhu said: "I have many books at home that I've finished reading. We can take them to those children."

"Great." Liang Shi perked up again. "Tomorrow after work, I'll go to a bookstore and buy some reference books. When I have time, I'll go deliver them."

"Sure." Xu Qingzhu said: "You can call me to come along."

"Okay."

The two discussed for a while, then both collapsed on the sofa.

Each lost in their own thoughts.

Footnotes:

None needed for this section.